

After serving in the Air Force, Clark completed degrees in aeronautical engineering and math, and he had a successful career as an applied physicist in the plastics industry. Clark has worked hard, invested wisely, avoided debt, and slowly grown his net worth from zero dollars when he first started tracking it on an Excel spreadsheet twenty years ago to over \$3 million today. He stayed away from flashy, high-risk investments and instead maxed out his company 401(k) plan. Once he and his wife hit fifty years old, they kicked things up a notch and maxed out their allowable “catch-up” contributions, throwing even more money into their 401(k)s. They stuck to mutual funds, which let them enjoy the growth of the market without the risks of single stocks. Through all this, Clark knew his financial success was in *his* hands and no one else’s. He says, “If I am a success, I can pat myself on the back. If I’m a failure, I have nobody else to blame but me.” It’s amazing how many millionaires told us something similar. Clearly, self-reliance is a key part of the average millionaire’s character.